UI & UX DESIGN ADVANCED DESIGN FUNDAMENTALS WITH FIGMA

MODULE 1: INTRODUCTION TO FIGMA

1. **What is UI/UX Design and Why it Matters**
    - **UI (User Interface) Design** focuses on the **look and layout** of a product, including buttons, colors, fonts, and screens.
    - **UX (User Experience) Design** focuses on the **overall experience** of a user while interacting with the product, ensuring it is **easy, efficient, and enjoyable**.
    - Importance: Good UI/UX design improves **user satisfaction, engagement, and usability**, reducing confusion and frustration.
2. **Overview of Figma: Features and Benefits**
    - **Cloud-based design tool** for web, mobile, and software interfaces.
    - Key features:
        - **Real-time collaboration** – multiple designers can work together simultaneously.
        - **Cross-platform** – works on Windows, macOS, Linux, and in a web browser.
        - **Design and prototyping** – create interactive prototypes without leaving the app.
        - **Components and Styles** – reuse elements like buttons, colors, and typography consistently.
    - Benefits: Easy sharing, teamwork, version control, and faster design workflow.
3. **Creating an Account and Exploring the Workspace**
    - Sign up at https://www.figma.com using **Google, Apple, or email**.
    - Workspace includes:
        - **Home screen / Dashboard** – access recent projects, templates, and team files.
        - **File Editor** – the canvas where you design and prototype screens.
        - **Frames** – act like artboards to design individual screens.

4. **Panels, Layers, and Menus**
    - **Toolbar** – tools for selection, shapes, text, pen, and prototyping.
    - **Layers Panel** – organize frames, groups, and individual objects.
    - **Properties Panel** – customize colors, typography, size, position, and effects.
    - **Assets Panel** – manage reusable components, colors, and styles.
    - **Menus** – access file options, export, plugins, and collaboration tools.

Practical Tasks

1. **Sign up for Figma**
    - Go to https://www.figma.com → Click **Sign Up** → Choose **Google, Apple, or email**.
2. **Explore the Home Screen, Tools, and Menus**
    - Open the dashboard → Create a **New File**.
    - Add a **Frame** for a mobile or web design.
    - Experiment with:
        - **Toolbar** – draw shapes, add text, and use selection tools.
        - **Layers Panel** – organize and rename layers.
        - **Properties Panel** – change colors, borders, shadows, and fonts.
        - **Assets Panel** – add or create reusable components.

Example Task

- Create a **blank Figma file**.
- Add a **frame** (e.g., iPhone 14).
- Draw shapes (rectangle, circle) and add a **text box**.
- Change colors and adjust size/position using the **Properties Panel**.
- Organize elements in the **Layers Panel**.
- Explore **Menus and Export options**.

✅ By completing this module, you will understand **UI/UX basics, Figma's workspace, tools, and panels**, and be ready to start designing interfaces.